

efficiently differentiating between vertical and horizontal surfaces, which makes quite a bit of difference.

Regardless of these current mapping issues, both platforms are doing a terrific job of creating authentic AR experiences by placing virtual objects accurately and naturally in real world environments - all of this minus any dangling or floating effects that could take away from the user's experience.

Putting It To The Test

If you are an end user of AR, you will probably not be extremely interested in which development tool was used to create the app that you are currently enjoying your experience on. However, this next bit is aimed at developers or companies that are looking to engineer their own AR apps. As the age-old adage goes, 'The proof lies in the pudding' - your best bet to see which one of the two ARCore or ARKit is better for you lies in trying them out for yourself.

Testing ARCore Apps

ARCore is the younger of the two SDKs, but has its fair share of options to try out. Try using some of these apps and demos -

Google Maps Virtual Position -

This one is rather interesting. It lets you, the user, explore real time Google Maps Street View by walking in physical space.

Mobile AR Tourist Information -

This one is probably the most utilitarian of the examples. While using the app, point your camera at a landscape feature or a signboard to see relevant AR tourist information such as driving/walking directions, related images, details of local accommodation options and other important data.

Beer Pong -

Who doesn't enjoy a good game of beer pong? Next time you could do it the AR way. This app lets you place virtual red cups on your table or desktop or any imaginable flat surface. Beer pong on the go, for you and your friends.

Testing ARKit Apps

ARKit has been around for a little while longer and boasts of a larger base of users. The largest available apps on ARKit for now might arguably be games.